

Voice building-block session

A recording list for one studio day. These are not songs, characters, or finished sound effects. They are **raw pieces** we will cut, layer, pitch, and process into everything in a simulation (water, rock, weather, small creatures, and so on).

If a take sounds a bit plain and “too close,” that is correct.

- **Time:** about 4–5 hours including breaks, or two shorter sessions
- **Format:** WAV · 48 kHz · 24-bit · mono preferred
- **Must finish:** sections 1 and 6. If we run out of time, stop after section 6.
- **Please stop** if the voice is tired. We can pick up later sections another day.

You will **not** need lyrics, melody, jazz repertoire, animal or instrument impressions, or acting.

How to sing and speak these

- **No words.** No “water,” no scat as a tune, no humming a song.
- **Long tones: no vibrato.** Straight, like a synth. Musical expression is only for the rise / fall items in section 4.
- **Hold still** on long tones. We need a boring, stable middle we can loop.
- Comfortable voice only. No screaming, no damage. “Pressed” means slightly effortful, not a belt.
- If a sound is unclear, do a spoken example first, then the take.
- Two takes of anything that felt unstable. Label them `_a` and `_b`.

Pitches — decide with the engineer in two minutes. Pick three notes you can hold easily, about an octave apart. Call them **LOW** / **MID** / **HIGH**. Use those all day. Write the note names in the delivery note (for example A2 / A3 / A4).

For the studio / engineer

- Dry room. No reverb, delay, chorus, or “make it nice.”
- One consistent close mic (about 15–20 cm). Same position the whole day.
- Pop filter **on** for long tones and air. Pop filter **off** for the short hits (section 6).
- Leave a little headroom. Do not brickwall.
- Slate each item: speak the **item number and name**, one second of silence, then the sound.
- One WAV per item. If an item is “20 hits,” that is still one file, hits separated by silence.

File name: `024_fall_fast_00.wav` (number from the list + short name)

Delivery: a folder of WAVs, plus a short text file of anything that was skipped or substituted.

Please do **not** send processed files, songs, or “I also made a water sound.” Extra experiments are welcome only if they are clearly labelled `EXTRA_` and kept separate.

0. Calibration

About 10 minutes.

#	What to record	How long
001	Room, you present, mouth closed, silence	45 seconds
002	Quiet breathing, natural, no performance	45 seconds
003	Speak this slate test: “slate test one two three”	once

1. Engines — long, steady, slightly boring

About 40 minutes. These are the most important recordings of the day.

Neutral **uh** (the vowel in *the*). Not “ah,” not “oo.”

#	What	Detail
004	Steady uh , LOW, quiet	12 seconds, straight tone
005	Steady uh , LOW, loud	12 seconds, still no scream
006	Steady uh , MID, quiet	12 seconds
007	Steady uh , MID, loud	12 seconds
008	Steady uh , HIGH, quiet	12 seconds
009	Steady uh , HIGH, loud	12 seconds
010	Air only: a long h (like fogging a mirror), quiet	12 seconds, almost no voice
011	Same h , loud	12 seconds
012	Vocal fry / creak drone, comfortable low	12 seconds, steady rattle
013	Vocal fry, a bit higher if easy	12 seconds — skip if 012 was the only comfortable one
014	Soft “uh-uh-uh” pulses, slow (~2 per second)	8 seconds, even
015	Same pulses, fast (~8 per second)	8 seconds, even

2. Vowel colours — long tones

About 25 minutes.

Each vowel twice: **normal voice**, then **whispered** (same mouth shape, no pitch). MID pitch, medium loud. **8 seconds**. Straight tone.

Say the word once in the slate so the vowel is obvious, then hold only the vowel.

#	Vowel	Like
016	ee voiced	<i>see</i>
017	ee whispered	<i>see</i>
018	eh voiced	<i>bed</i>
019	eh whispered	<i>bed</i>
020	ah voiced	<i>father</i>

#	Vowel	Like
021	ah whispered	<i>father</i>
022	oh voiced	<i>go</i> (pure, not a slide)
023	oh whispered	<i>go</i>
024	oo voiced	<i>food</i>
025	oo whispered	<i>food</i>
026	uh voiced	<i>the</i>
027	uh whispered	<i>the</i>

3. Hisses and air shapes

About 20 minutes.

No pitch. Hold the consonant, then a second take that **starts quiet and swells to loud**.

#	Sound	Take
028	f (<i>four</i>)	hold 8 seconds
029	f	swell ~4 seconds
030	s (<i>see</i>)	hold 8 seconds
031	s	swell ~4 seconds
032	sh (<i>shoe</i>)	hold 8 seconds
033	sh	swell ~4 seconds
034	Harsh ch as in Scottish <i>loch</i> , or a raspy whispered ah if <i>loch</i> is awkward	hold 8 seconds
035	Same	swell ~4 seconds
036	v (<i>very</i>) or z (<i>zoo</i>) — pick one and stick to it	hold 8 seconds
037	Same	swell ~4 seconds

4. Moves — rise, fall, arch, “wah”

About 45 minutes.

Now you can be a little more like a singer. Still **no tune** and **no words**. One clean gesture per take.

- **Slow** ≈ 3–4 seconds
- **Fast** ≈ half a second, still clear, not sloppy

Rise = slide up about an octave. **Fall** = slide down about an octave. **Arch** = up, then down, same range.

#	Gesture	On this vowel
038	Rise slow	ah
039	Rise fast	ah

#	Gesture	On this vowel
040	Fall slow	ah
041	Fall fast	ah
042	Arch slow	ah
043	Arch fast	ah
044	Rise slow	ee
045	Rise fast	ee
046	Fall slow	ee
047	Fall fast	ee
048	Arch slow	ee
049	Arch fast	ee
050	Rise slow	oo
051	Rise fast	oo
052	Fall slow	oo
053	Fall fast	oo
054	Arch slow	oo
055	Arch fast	oo
056	Rise slow	mm (mouth closed, hummed)
057	Rise fast	mm
058	Fall slow	mm
059	Fall fast	mm
060	Arch slow	mm
061	Arch fast	mm

Wah = keep a tone and move the mouth: **oo** → **ah** → **oo**, or **mm** → **ah** → **mm**. The pitch stays put; the colour moves.

#	What
062	Wah slow on ah (start from oo)
063	Wah fast on ah (start from oo)
064	Wah slow, closed: mm → ah → mm
065	Wah fast, closed: mm → ah → mm
066	Lip trill (brrr), steady pitch, 4 seconds
067	Tongue roll (rrrr) if you have one, 4 seconds — skip if not

5. Texture variants

About 15 minutes.

Same two vowels only: **ah** and **uh**. 8 seconds each, unless noted.

#	What
068	ah , breathy / airy
069	uh , breathy / airy
070	ah , pressed (some effort, not a yell)
071	uh , pressed
072	ah , wet mouth (a little saliva is useful)
073	uh , wet mouth
074	Inward breath that sounds like h (air in, not out), 8 seconds
075	Inward s , 8 seconds
076	Hum mm , 12 seconds, MID, straight
077	Hum nn , 12 seconds, MID, straight

6. Short hits — pop filter off

About 40 minutes.

We will cut these up. **One file per sound type**. About **20 hits** in a row, small silence between them. Vary them a bit (a little harder / softer / shorter) but keep the same consonant.

Imagine tapping a table, not performing.

#	Hit	Notes
078	p	<i>pat</i> — just the pop
079	t	<i>tap</i>
080	k	<i>cat</i>
081	b	softer than p
082	d	softer than t
083	Glottal stop	the catch in <i>uh-oh</i> , just the catch, ~20 times
084	ts or ch	<i>cats</i> / <i>chip</i> — tiny ticks
085	Tongue clicks	<i>tsk</i> , ~20
086	Lip pops	small lip release, ~20
087	Wet lip smacks	only if you are comfortable, ~15
088	Optional: very small wet mouth ticks	skip without guilt

7. If the voice is still happy (optional)

About 15 minutes. Do not trade these for missing sections 1–6.

#	What	How long
089	Whistle register or high flute-tone, long, if it is easy	8 seconds
090	Same, a short rise and a short fall	two gestures
091	Repeat 004 and 010 at the end (the voice is different; useful)	12 seconds each

Please skip rather than substitute

If something is impossible that day, skip it and write it down. A hole we know about is better than a substitute that is actually a different sound.

Please do not send:

- A finished “water sound” or “monster sound”
- Songs, improvisations, or unlabelled extras
- Processed files (no reverb, no pitch plugins on the recordings)
- Takes with words

Why the plain takes matter

We will treat **004–015** as engines, **016–037** as colours, **038–067** as moves, **068–077** as textures, and **078–088** as hits. One later cue might be three of your files stacked and pitched. You do not need to imagine the game. If the take is clean, steady, and labelled, it is useful.

Thank you.

Stand cheat-sheet

Print this page and put it on the stand. Slate the number, then do the take.

#	Slate name
001	room silence
002	quiet breath
003	slate test
004	uh low quiet
005	uh low loud
006	uh mid quiet
007	uh mid loud
008	uh high quiet
009	uh high loud
010	air h quiet
011	air h loud

#	Slate name
012	fry low
013	fry higher
014	pulse slow
015	pulse fast
016	ee voiced
017	ee whisper
018	eh voiced
019	eh whisper
020	ah voiced
021	ah whisper
022	oh voiced
023	oh whisper
024	oo voiced
025	oo whisper
026	uh voiced
027	uh whisper
028	f hold
029	f swell
030	s hold
031	s swell
032	sh hold
033	sh swell
034	loch hold
035	loch swell
036	v-or-z hold
037	v-or-z swell
038	rise slow ah
039	rise fast ah
040	fall slow ah
041	fall fast ah
042	arch slow ah
043	arch fast ah
044	rise slow ee
045	rise fast ee

#	Slate name
046	fall slow ee
047	fall fast ee
048	arch slow ee
049	arch fast ee
050	rise slow oo
051	rise fast oo
052	fall slow oo
053	fall fast oo
054	arch slow oo
055	arch fast oo
056	rise slow mm
057	rise fast mm
058	fall slow mm
059	fall fast mm
060	arch slow mm
061	arch fast mm
062	wah slow ah
063	wah fast ah
064	wah slow mm
065	wah fast mm
066	lip trill
067	tongue roll
068	ah breathy
069	uh breathy
070	ah pressed
071	uh pressed
072	ah wet
073	uh wet
074	inward h
075	inward s
076	hum mm
077	hum nn
078	hits p
079	hits t

#	Slate name
080	hits k
081	hits b
082	hits d
083	hits glottal
084	hits ts
085	hits clicks
086	hits lip pops
087	hits wet smacks
088	hits wet ticks
089	whistle hold
090	whistle rise fall
091	repeat uh-low and air